

POOP DECK

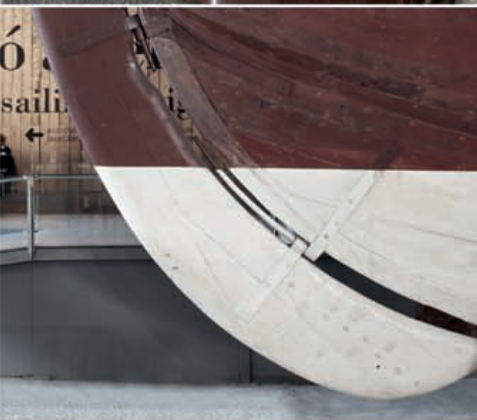
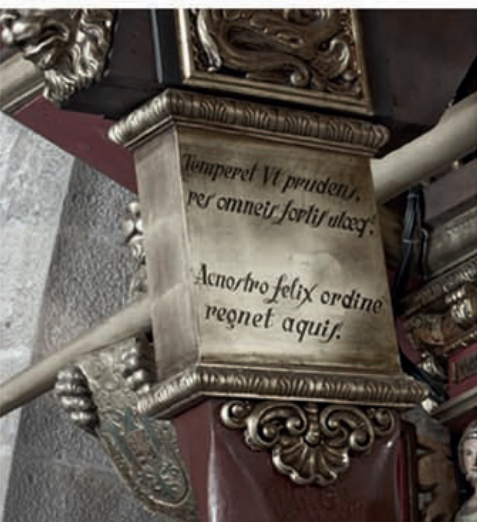


▲ BOARDING STEPS

A pair of curved ladders, one on either side of the poop deck, were used for embarking and disembarking.

▼ LATIN MOTTO

The rudder's inscription extols prudence and strength – virtues needed to rule the waves.

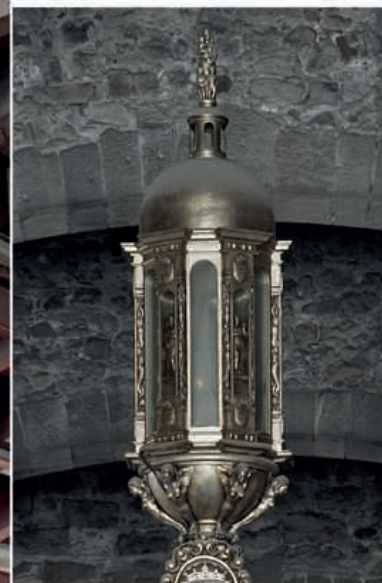


▲ RUDDER

Galley rudders were smaller than those on sailing ships, and curved rather than straight.

▼ NIGHT LIGHT

Above the helmsman's position on the poop deck are three large, ornate lanterns. They were used as beacons for keeping the fleet together at night.



▲ POOP DECOR AND CANOPY

The backrests of the benches depict episodes from Greek myths, most of which have a nautical theme and a moral message. An awning was draped over the canopy to keep out the sun, wind, and rain, and to give protection in battle.